

Sexual reproduction

The changes that happen to young people during puberty prepare their bodies to be capable of sexual reproduction when they are older.

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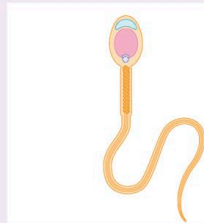
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What is sexual reproduction?

Sexual reproduction is the result of the fusion of two sex cells, the female egg and the male sperm, to produce an embryo. During sex, sperm is ejaculated out of a male's penis into a female's vagina, and travels up through the uterus. Although most males produce millions of sperm, just one is needed to fertilize the egg. The fused egg and sperm then start to divide and grow into a cluster of cells. Within 3–4 days, these cells leave the fallopian tube, enter the uterus, and attach to the lining of the uterus, where they develop into an embryo.

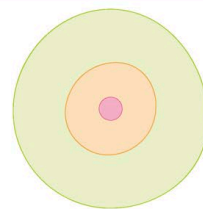
▽ Fertilization

Fertilization can happen if vaginal sex occurs, without contraception, when the female has released an egg.



△ Sperm

This is the male sex cell. During orgasm, up to 250 million sperm can be ejaculated from the penis into the vagina in a fluid called semen.



△ Egg

This is the female sex cell. On average, one of the two ovaries releases an egg every 28 days. This is known as ovulation.

